Wild Australasia – Exploring the Natural History of Australia

How was Australia formed?

The supercontinent of Gondwana separated and Australia moved north.

List and describe each type of landscape as shown in the video:

Landscape	Description
Rainforests of Tasmania	
Australian Alps	
Northern Tropical Rainforests	
Eucalypt Forests	
River Systems and Billabongs	
Deserts	
Great Barrier Reef	Shallow water, the largest living thing on earth. Formed during the last ice age, 10,000 years ago.

What is a structural adaptation?

Body part which helps an organism to survive in its environment. For example, strong claws or sharp teeth.

What is a functional adaptation?

The way an organism’s body functions which helps it to survive. For example, being immune to venom.

What is a behavioural adaptation?

The way an organism behaves which helps it to survive. For example, being nocturnal.

Why are bushfires important to the Australian bush?

Fire and smoke can help some seeds to germinate.

Why are there more reptiles in the desert than mammals?

Mammals are warm blooded and therefore require more energy. Ectothermic animals like reptiles do not require as much food, which is often scarce in the desert.

What is the single biggest breeding event on Earth?

Simultaneous release of eggs and sperm from the Great Barrier Reef.

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Animal	Structural Adaptations	Functional Adaptations	Behavioural Adaptations
Tasmanian Devil	Powerful jaw, claws Sharp teeth		Scream and fight Nocturnal
Wombat	Claws for digging		
Platypus	Webbed feet, can attack prey with their beak		
Sugar Glider	front teeth are very long and sharp semi-prehensile tails, can hold and carry small things in them		
Kangaroo	Large, strong tendons in their hind legs which act as springs	Produce two different types of milk Can survive a long time without water	More active in the cooler hours of the early morning and the late afternoon
Koala	Strong claws for climbing	Sleep to give time for digestion	Baby depends on mother up to 1 yr old
Kookaburra and Budgerigar	Jaw and beak is quite strong		Catch many types of food. Offspring help to care for younger chicks.
Corella Parrot	Long beak		Fly in numbers
Merton's Water Monitor	Long, powerful tail	Can taste rotting food	Scavengers
Freshwater Crocodile		Ectothermic	Feed on small fish and crustaceans Travel over land when water dries up
Goanna	Fast	Immune to scorpion venom	Eat anything they can find